Even as unsubstantiated allegations flew thick and fast, direct interference in the SSNCo's business also continued apace. In the last week of June, Wynch met C. Vijayaraghavachari in Tirunelveli to discuss the affairs of the company. The collector's report gives interesting details on the company's or at least the Vijayaraghavachari faction's thinking at this time. The meeting probably took place at the instance of Vijayaraghavachari: the reason was to appeal to Wynch to use his good offices in negotiating with Eric Chapman, the BI's Tuticorin man. 'Like a mining company,' Wynch argued, the SSNCo's strategy was to keep investing in the expectation that eventually it would become a viable concern. Though conceding that the company was practically bankrupt, Vijayaraghavachari, Wynch gathered, was not willing to be a party to its liquidation. To this end, he was prepared even going to the extent of approaching BI and negotiate *any* terms including amending the reconstitution of the company to appoint skilled European managers or managing agencies. 'The appeal' to its rival British company, the collector described as *ad misericordiam* (i.e. an emotional appeal to one's sense of pity). Though Wynch confessed that he had not discussed this with BI, he said it was possible to agree on rates and that a *modus vivendi* could be worked out.[57] But he wondered, what would BI gain by helping SSNCo to stand on its own legs? Only one steamer was operational. Rs 40,000 were still due on the *Gallia*, and the company had bought time to pay it. Though a sense of disappointment that the company was not going to collapse immediately runs through Wynch's report, he was relieved that if 'the smash' coincided with VOC's conviction (which in Wynch's view was a foregone conclusion) 'there would be a universal howl'. In short, SSNCo could 'scarcely hope to do more than postpone the evil day when they must go into liquidation'.[58]